EXECUTIVE ORDER NO. PCG-39
Series of 2026

AN EXECUTIVE ORDER ESTABLISHING THE IMPLEMENTING GUIDELINES ON THE GRANT OF WELLNESS LEAVE TO OFFICIALS AND EMPLOYEES OF THE CITY GOVERNMENT OF PASIG PURSUANT TO CIVIL SERVICE COMMISSION ISSUANCES

WHEREAS, Sections 1 and 2, Rule VIII of the Omnibus Rules Implementing Book V of Executive Order No. 292 and other pertinent Civil Service laws direct every government agency to foster a work environment that supports employees' personal growth, welfare, and development, including programs on counselling, recreation, and overall well-being;

WHEREAS, the Civil Service Commission, through Resolution No. 2501292 and Memorandum Circular No. 01, s. 2026, institutionalized the grant of Wellness Leave as a stand-alone leave benefit for government officials and employees to promote their holistic well-being;

WHEREAS, Republic Act No. 11036, otherwise known as the Mental Health Act, mandates the promotion of mental health and well-being in the workplace, including the establishment of mechanisms that support the psychological and emotional needs of employees;

WHEREAS, Republic Act No. 10173, or the Data Privacy Act of 2012, and applicable data privacy policies of the City Government of Pasig ensure the protection, confidentiality, and security of personal and sensitive information, particularly those relating to employees' health and wellness;

WHEREAS, the City Government of Pasig recognizes the importance of promoting the emotional and mental well-being of its workforce through accessible, responsive, and employee-centered wellness programs and services;

WHEREAS, there is a need to adopt and operationalize a Wellness Leave Policy for the City Government of Pasig to ensure compliance with Civil Service Commission issuances, existing laws, data privacy standards, and the City's employee wellness and mental health initiatives;

NOW, THEREFORE, I, VICTOR MA REGIS N. SOTTO, Mayor of the City of Pasig, by virtue of the powers vested in me by law, do hereby order:

SECTION 1. COVERAGE. – These guidelines shall apply to all eligible officials and permanent, temporary, casual, coterminous, fixed-term and contractual employees of the City Government of Pasig.

SECTION 2. DEFINITION OF WELLNESS LEAVE. – Wellness Leave refers to a stand-alone leave benefit granted to eligible employees to support their overall physical, mental, and emotional well-being. It may be availed of for purposes including, but not limited to: (i) mental health care; (ii) participation in physical wellness activities; and/or (iii) general rest and recovery from work-related demands.

Wellness Leave is distinct from, and shall not be charged against Vacation Leave, Sick Leave, or any other leave privileges authorized under existing laws, rules, and regulations. It is

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granted in recognition of the importance of preventive care, work-life balance, and sustained employee productivity in the public service.

SECTION 3. GUIDELINES FOR ENTITLEMENT. – Eligible officials and employees shall be entitled to Wellness Leave, subject to the terms and conditions provided in this Executive Order, as follows:

1. Eligible officials and employees shall be entitled to a maximum of five (5) days of Wellness Leave per calendar year, which may be availed of either consecutively for a maximum of three (3) days per instance or on separate, non-consecutive days.

2. It shall be non-cumulative and non-commutable. Any unused days shall be forfeited at the end of the calendar year.

3. The Wellness Leave may be availed of, for purposes including, but not limited to, mental health care, physical wellness activities, or general break from work.

SECTION 4. APPLICATION AND APPROVAL. – The filing, review, approval, and documentation of Wellness Leave applications shall be subject to the following procedures:

A. **Application Requirements**

1. Employees shall file their Wellness Leave applications through the Government Employees Management System (GEMS) indicating the intended dates of availment and wellness-related purpose.

2. Employees shall ensure that all information provided is complete and accurate.

B. **Review and Approval**

1. The employee's immediate supervisor shall review the application to ensure its completeness and reasonableness, assess its operational impact, ensure appropriate workload distribution or reliever arrangements, and recommend its approval or disapproval.

2. The Head of Office or duly authorized Approving Authority shall act on the recommendation of the immediate supervisor and approve or disapprove the application, taking into consideration the exigencies of the service, office priorities, staffing requirements, and the need to ensure continuity of public service.

3. The immediate supervisor and the Head of Office or duly authorized Approving Authority shall act on Wellness Leave applications within the prescribed processing periods under existing service standards.

4. All approved, disapproved, or cancelled Wellness Leave applications shall be recorded and monitored through GEMS for leave administration, documentation, and reporting purposes.

C. **Time of Filing**

1. Wellness Leave applications shall be filed at least five (5) working days before the intended date of availment to facilitate workload planning and ensure uninterrupted delivery of public services.

2. In emergency or unforeseen circumstances that prevent prior filing, the employee shall submit the Wellness Leave application immediately upon return to duty. Such applications shall be evaluated with due regard for the employee's well-being, while ensuring proper documentation and compliance with applicable data privacy and confidentiality requirements.

D. **Recording and Monitoring**

1. The Human Resource Development Office (HRDO) shall review approved Wellness Leave applications for compliance with applicable Civil Service Commission issuances and internal guidelines.

2. The HRDO shall record and monitor all approved, disapproved, or cancelled Wellness Leave applications through GEMS for leave administration, documentation, and reporting purposes, and shall provide guidance to ensure the consistent implementation of this Executive Order across all offices.

SECTION 5. CONFIDENTIALITY. – The processing, handling, storage, and disclosure of information relating to the availment of Wellness Leave shall be governed by the following confidentiality and data privacy safeguards:

1. All utilization, processing, and documentation related to Wellness Leave shall be undertaken in strict compliance with Republic Act No. 10173, or the Data Privacy Act of 2012, its implementing rules and regulations, applicable local data privacy policies, and the established mental health policies of the City Government of Pasig. All information relating to the availment of Wellness Leave, particularly those involving mental health concerns, shall be treated with the highest degree of confidentiality.

2. Any supporting documents or disclosures relating to an employee's mental health condition that are voluntarily submitted shall be processed only for lawful purposes, safeguarded against unauthorized access, and securely maintained by the HRDO or other authorized personnel. Access thereto shall be limited to officials duly authorized under applicable laws, rules, regulations, and city policies.

3. All officials and employees involved in the processing, approval, documentation, and recording of Wellness Leave applications shall ensure compliance with applicable data privacy and confidentiality requirements and shall be held accountable for any unauthorized disclosure or breach in accordance with applicable laws, rules, regulations, and city policies.

SECTION 6. RECORDKEEPING. – The HRDO shall maintain accurate, updated, and secure records of Wellness Leave utilization, which shall be recorded separately from other leave credits to ensure proper monitoring, transparency, and accountability in support of the City Government of Pasig's commitment to efficient, responsive, and people-centered public service.

SECTION 7. SEPARABILITY CLAUSE. – If for any reason, any part or provision of this Order is held unconstitutional or invalid, other parts or provisions hereof which are not affected thereby shall continue to be in full force and effect.

SECTION 8. REPEALING CLAUSE. – Any order or issuance, or parts thereof, that are inconsistent with the provisions of this order are hereby repealed or modified accordingly.

SECTION 9. DISSEMINATION. – A copy of this Executive Order shall be furnished to the Office of the President and Metropolitan Manila Development Authority (MMDA) for information and guidance pursuant to Section 455(1)(xiii) of the RA 7160 otherwise known as the Local Government Code, as amended, and shall be posted at the official website of the Pasig City Government.

SECTION 10. EFFECTIVITY. – This Order shall take effect immediately.

DONE this 15th day of July 2026 at the City of Pasig, Metro Manila.

VICTOR MA REGIS N. SOTTO
City Mayor

City Government of Pasig
Officially Released
JASMIN A. BAITO
SUPERVISING ADMINISTRATIVE OFFICER
Date/Time
Records Mgt & Archives Office
15 JUL 2026 1:30PM